customer demand or as warranted by circumstances such as weather-related cancellations. In this use case, you'll limit the scope to the elemental operation of peer-to-peer sales of flight seats among airlines. Enforcement of agreed rules of engagement and a seamless payment system is also enabled by the blockchain, alleviating the traditional business concerns of competing airlines. The participating airlines expose secure, standard APIs for simple queries about the availability of flight seats. These queries are like those you might post on a travel website like Kayak or Expedia (intermediaries), but with one significant difference: they are initiated programmatically by the software applications, and there are no intermediaries. An application requests trades from the airlines directly on your behalf.

2.6.2 Sequence of operations

Here are the steps followed by two airlines, A and B, that are not necessarily known to each other and that operate beyond the boundaries of traditional trust. In other words, they don't have a conventional business partnership such as code-sharing and alliances. How can the airlines trust each other to verify and record the transactions?

Consider this everyday situation: your sister wants to borrow $10, all in $1 bills. You take the bills out of your wallet, count them, verify there are 10 $1 bills, and hand them to her. She pockets the bills and leaves. She does not count them again because she trusts you.